



1935

GERMANY INTRODUCES THE NUREMBERG LAWS

At a rally in the city of Nuremberg, the Nazi party announced racist laws restricting citizenship to people “of German or related blood” and forbidding marriage or sexual relations between Germans and Jews, later expanded to apply also to Roma and Black people. Those considered not “of German blood” were deprived of normal citizenship rights. The laws led to widespread persecution of the minority groups both by the state and the population at large, who were discouraged from any social contact.

◁ Chart defining racial categories under the laws

1935

1935 Persia
formally becomes known as Iran at its ruler's request

1935

ITALY INVADES ABYSSINIA (ETHIOPIA)

Italy's Fascist leader Mussolini ordered a force of 200,000 soldiers into what is now Ethiopia in a war of aggression. After 16 months of fighting, the nation's ruler Haile Selassie was forced into exile, and Abyssinia was declared an Italian colony. Hundreds of thousands of Abyssinian civilians were killed.



△ An Abyssinian warrior

1936 Arabs revolt in Palestine against British occupying forces

1936

SPANISH CIVIL WAR BEGINS

Following a Popular Front victory in a general election in Spain, Nationalist forces under General Francisco Franco staged an attempted coup. Republican forces, including Communist and anarchist contingents, took up arms to resist them. The struggle lasted for almost three years, but eventually the Nationalists were able to draw on military support from Nazi Germany and Fascist Italy to achieve a decisive victory. In its wake, Franco would remain in power as Spain's leader until his death in 1975.



△ Republican poster urges a united war effort